

Wearable computers

In recent years, computers have become small enough to wear and may be equipped with a variety of sensors. This has opened up a whole new range of uses and applications for them.

Smartwatches

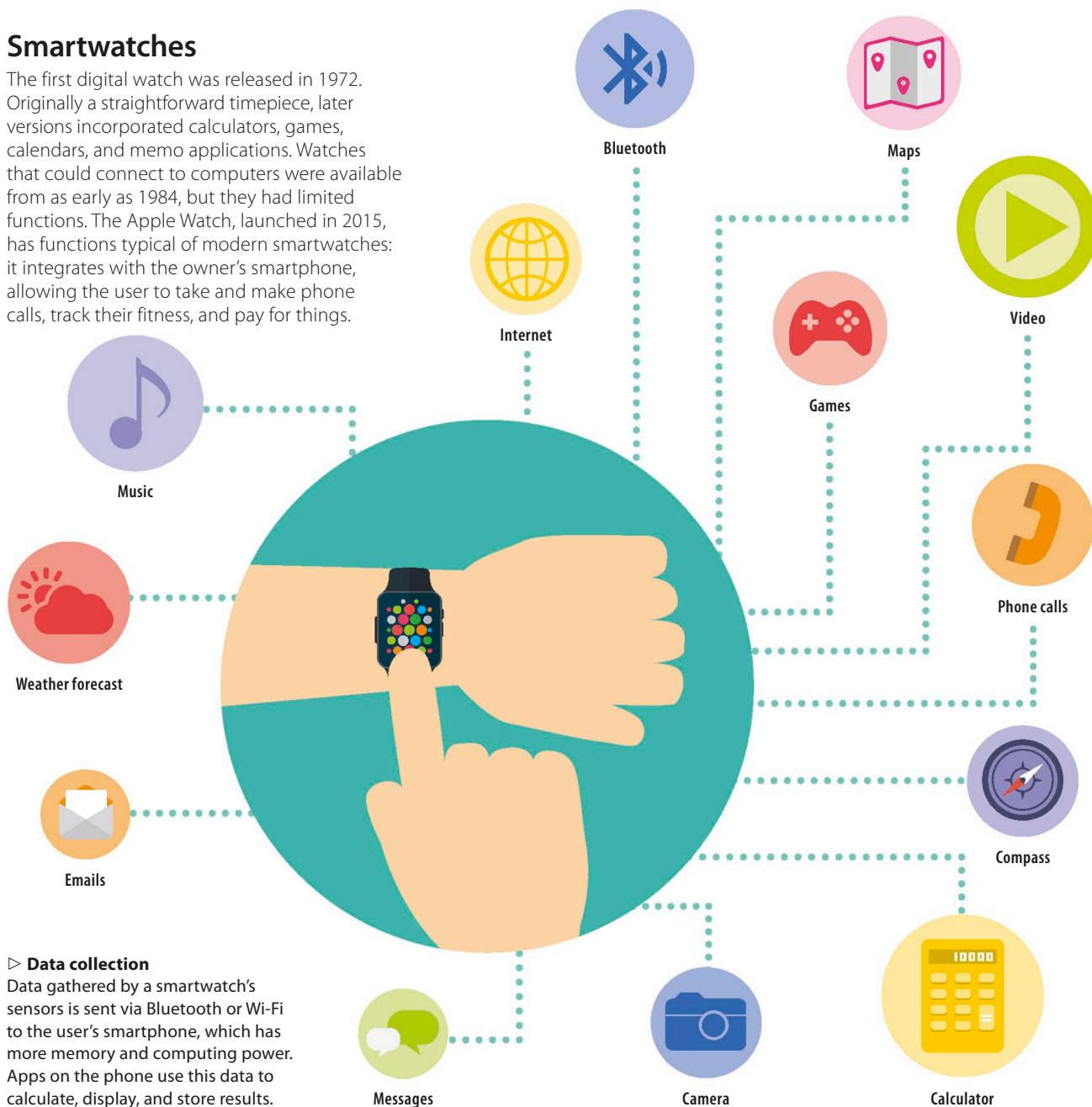
The first digital watch was released in 1972. Originally a straightforward timepiece, later versions incorporated calculators, games, calendars, and memo applications. Watches that could connect to computers were available from as early as 1984, but they had limited functions. The Apple Watch, launched in 2015, has functions typical of modern smartwatches: it integrates with the owner's smartphone, allowing the user to take and make phone calls, track their fitness, and pay for things.

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► Data collection

Data gathered by a smartwatch's sensors is sent via Bluetooth or Wi-Fi to the user's smartphone, which has more memory and computing power. Apps on the phone use this data to calculate, display, and store results.